

Rock your Phone

RYP, the alternative to iPhone's App Store is doing extremely well with applications such as IntelliScreen. The application creates a much better home screen for the iPhone, and many of the applications on RYP, are restricted on the App store

Mobile Woes

Handset sales are expected to decline 20 per cent in the current year and of the handsets that are sold about 33 per cent of them will be replacements

Feature

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Always on

The culture of connectivity

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Back in the days when the world was new to WAP, we all had simple phones with which we could connect to web sites and download Java games. Some of the more savvy ones would go to MSN every now and then to check email or install Java applications such as *Talkonaut* that would allow users simultaneously to sign into the MSN, Yahoo and Google chat networks. That was all there was to mobile internet usage. We've significantly evolved ever since. Now you have high-end phones

with full internet capability. Carriers have introduced GPRS services where you can have a complete browsing experience through mobile browsers such as Opera Mini. This has made the mobile phone the new face of the internet.

With your mobile, you can now always stay connected to the vast stream of information that is constantly flowing across the world wide web. Mobile devices are no longer used only to call people, but are an interface that lets you connect better with all your social groups. You can send pictures to friends as you click them, find out where they are through services such as Google Latitude, post location-

specific tagged content and engage in loads of other activities.

The first wave of the "always on" mentality was propelled by Google and Wikipedia. As any information-hungry user would tell you, the thirst for that prickly bit of information which is nagging your brain cannot be put aside until you have a PC. It has to be fulfilled then and there. So, people started using their mobile phones to access Google in an effort to look for everything from varieties of coffee to phone numbers of businesses and services such as cinema halls.

India has approximately 350 million mobile phone subscribers. Of these, about